Ankle Tag

G31 / TEAM FAVORITE / SUGGESTED 4 MINUTES

Paired, touch-only ankle tag.

SET UP

Equipment: Clear mat space. Optional: soft, flat, washable wrestling ankle bands as visible targets only; no hard parts or loose ends.

Match partners by size, experience, and control. Give each pair a clear area with space between pairs. Demonstrate a gentle open-hand ankle touch and the stop signal.

HOW TO PLAY

Stay with your assigned partner. A gentle touch to an ankle scores one point; no grip or takedown. The reset and scoring below are suggested coaching choices.

1. Begin in a comfortable wrestling stance with eyes up and hands ready. Move your feet to stay balanced.

2. Reach with an open hand and gently touch your partner's ankle. Never hold the ankle, shoe, sock, or band.

3. After a touch, say "one," separate, and return to stance before restarting. Stop and reset if the pair leaves its area.

4. Use the suggested short rounds below, then pause to reset or switch the attacker. Keep every athlete involved.

SUGGESTED ADAPTATIONS

Suggested age adaptations: ages 4-6 / Pup: 15-20 seconds, cooperative, one attacker at a time; switch roles. Ages 7-10: 20-30 seconds, both may score when they show control. Ages 11-14: 30-40 seconds, add a footwork challenge while keeping the same gentle touch rule. Choose a shorter round whenever control fades.

COACH WATCH

Touch only. No diving, gripping, pushing, tripping, sweeping, or takedowns. Never grab, pull, or remove an ankle band. A band is a visual target, not a flag to collect. Stop immediately if partners collide, fall, or become rough.

Say this: Touch, do not grab. | Move your feet; stay balanced. | One touch, reset.

RELATED DEMONSTRATION & SOURCE

USA Wrestling: Level 1 - Drills, Activities and Games - Toe Tag
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_sVdY3tjqjg
Official games curriculum: usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/7

Related video, not these exact team rules. Official curriculum link and metadata checked October 10, 2026; footage not watched. Use hand-to-ankle touches, never foot-stepping.

Team favorite shared by a coach. Added round lengths, resets, scoring/rotation, and age choices are suggestions.

Bulldog

G32 / TEAM FAVORITE / SUGGESTED 5 MINUTES

Also called Sharks and Minnows. Team rule: hip to mat = new shark.

SET UP

Equipment: Clear mat space and two visible end lines. Keep the playing area away from walls, chairs, and other groups.

Everyone moves on hands and knees. Choose one starting shark in the middle; minnows begin behind one end line. Use a short crossing lane and enough space to separate pairs. Coach first demonstrates a controlled body action the athletes have already learned that guides a partner's hip gently to the mat. If they cannot show it cooperatively, use the torso-touch adaptation.

HOW TO PLAY

On the coach's signal, minnows crawl toward the opposite end line. The team's core rule is hip to mat = new shark. The release, entry timing, and rotation below are suggested coaching choices.

1. Allow only one shark to engage each minnow. Other sharks must choose an unengaged minnow; never add a second athlete to an active pair.

2. Using only the previously taught controlled body action, the shark guides the minnow's hip gently to the mat. Keep contact controlled; no lifting or forcing.

3. As soon as the hip touches, the shark releases. Both athletes separate. The new shark joins on the next crossing, after the current crossing ends.

4. Reset everyone on hands and knees before the next signal. Use short rounds, rotate the starting shark, and restart before crowding or fatigue spoils control.

SUGGESTED ADAPTATIONS

Suggested age adaptations: Pup / ages 4-6 and any new athlete: gentle torso touch only, with no tipping; touched minnows join as sharks on the next crossing. Ages 7-10 and 11-14: rehearse the selected controlled hip finish with a cooperative partner first; use it only when every athlete can perform and receive it calmly. Readiness, not age, decides the version. Suggested format: 30-45-second rounds with a reset and a new starting shark.

COACH WATCH

No piling on, lifts, headlocks, neck pulls, twisting trapped legs, or dragging by joints or clothing. No standing, running, tackling, or force progression. Release immediately at the hip touch or stop signal. Pause the whole game if an athlete is trapped, uncomfortable, or loses control; return to touch-only play.

Say this: Hands and knees. | One shark, one minnow. | Hip touches: release and reset.

RELATED DEMONSTRATION & SOURCE

USA Wrestling: Level 1 - Drills, Activities and Games - Sharks & Minnows
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ByuqM7Itd1o
Official games curriculum: usawmembership.com/usa_wrestling_core_curriculum/7

Related video, not these exact team rules. Official curriculum link and metadata checked October 10, 2026; footage not watched. Crawling/hug Bulldog is another variation; use the written team rules here.

Team favorite shared by a coach. Added round lengths, resets, scoring/rotation, and age choices are suggestions.